2021–22 at Rs 135.87 lakh crore. A press release on India's GDP in May 2021 placed India's GDP, in current prices, for 2019–20 at Rs 203.5 lakh crore and for 2020–21 at Rs 197.5 lakh crore. If India's nominal GDP grows by 12 per cent in 2021–22, it is likely to be around Rs 221.2 lakh crore. This results in the debt to GDP ratio of Central government debt and liabilities to be 50.4 per cent for the year 2019–20, 61.4 per cent for the year 2020–21 and almost the same 61.3 per cent in 2021–22.

Total liabilities of the Central government were Rs 4.27 lakh crore in 1991–92, as per the data in the *Handbook of Statistics on Indian Economy*, published by RBI. These liabilities rose to Rs 114.4 lakh crore in 2019–20. Total liabilities of the state governments were Rs 1.28 lakh crore in 1990–91. These reached Rs 52.58 lakh crore by 2019–20. The combined liabilities of the Centre and states were Rs 5.58 lakh crore in 1991–92, which rose to Rs 146.90 lakh crore in 2019–20. The Central government's liabilities rose by about twenty-seven times during this period, state governments' liabilities rose by about forty-one times and combined liabilities rose by twenty-six times. The combined liabilities are after cancelling the loans from the Centre to the States.

Central government debt and liabilities have been rising mostly in double digits during the past three decades, with a rise of under 10 per cent limited to only three out of twenty-nine years. The lowest growth in debt and liabilities was recorded in 2016–17 (7.42 per cent) and the highest in 2001–02 (15.62 per cent).

India's GDP has also been rising at a fair pace since 1991–92. IMF data indicates that India's general government gross debt to GDP ratio was 68.3 per cent in 2011. This ratio came down to 66.8 per cent in 2014, declining in all the three years in between. It then started rising to reach 69.6 per cent in 2018 and 72.3 per cent in 2019. Taking into account the impact of COVID-19 on GDP contraction and rise in public expenditures, the IMF